

Who Pays and Who Decides: The First Promise

谁承担，谁决定：第一次承诺

Theme: 社会问题、经济与公共生活 · New: 44 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 44/6,127

English Story

The first promise of the arc was made in a room with a red banner and a **bear** on the city crest: the **meeting** would **show** the **evidence**, not the **party** line. “A **democratic** process is not a **party** conference,” the **representative** said. “It is a **jury** with an **audience**.”

The **poor** would be hurt first and the **corporate lobby** last, and everybody in the room knew it. “We must **introduce** the numbers before the vote,” Maya wrote in her **article**. “A **minority** of ten thousand people cannot **bear** a revolution in fares alone.” The **transcript** of the **meeting** would be published in full, including the **confession** that the first estimate had been **wrong**.

The **conservative** member, the **progressive** member, and the **politician** from the east district all had a **bond** with the utilities. “We **acknowledge** the **allegation**,” the mayor said. “We do not accept the **nuisance** of a closed budget.” A **jail** sentence for **piracy** of the city's software was on the same agenda, which made the room laugh bitterly.

The **revenue** question was harder than the **taxation** question. “A **terrorism** trial, a **terrorist** arrest, a **vacation** cancelled: none of that helps us fund a treatment plant,” the treasurer said. “What helps is a **fare** that a **poor** family can pay.”

The promise was to publish the **succession** of costs and the **defection** of the suppliers before the next session. A **contentious reformation** of the **fare** system, a **condemnation** from the **lobby**, and a **socialize** programme for the water users were all on the list.

The imagine part was the hardest: to ask the couple at the fair, the leg of the west market, and the natural scepticism of the tea stall what they would pay. “A direct question is worth a stick of **evidence**,” Lin said. “We will **introduce** nothing that the **audience** cannot see.” Different people, the same difficulty: a direct question about the east market, the fair, the floor of the west hall, and the leg of the investment. We could imagine the hurt of a **poor** family, but the tea and the stick of **evidence** had to be produced before the vote. The **world versus** the city, a brain versus a budget, a republican versus a **progressive**: a **bankruptcy**, a **convert**, and an **outing** were all that the **party** could offer.

中文翻译

这段弧线的第一个承诺是在一间挂着红色横幅、市徽上有一只熊的房间里做出的：会议将展示证据，而不是党派立场。“民主程序不是党代表大会，”那位代表说，“它是一个有听众的陪审团。”

穷人会最先受伤，企业游说集团最后，而屋里的每个人都知道这一点。“我们必须在表决之前把数字摆出来，”曼雅在她的文章里写道，“一万人的少数群体承担不起票价上的一场革命。”会议的文字记录将全文公布，包括承认第一次估算错了这件事。

保守派成员、进步派成员，以及来自东区的政客，都与公用事业公司有一条纽带。“我们承认这一指控，”市长说，“我们不接受一个封闭预算带来的麻烦。”议程上还有一条对盗用城市软件的海盗行为的监禁判决，这让屋里苦笑起来。

收入问题比税收问题更难。“一场恐怖主义审判、一次恐怖分子抓捕、一个被取消的假期：这些都不能帮我们给水处理厂筹到钱，”司库说，“有用的是一个贫穷家庭付得起的票价。”

这个承诺是在下次会议之前公开成本的连续变化和供应商的背弃。票价体系一场有争议的改革、来自游说集团的一份谴责，以及一个面向用水者的社会化项目，都在清单上。

需要想象的部分最难：去问展会上的那对夫妇、西市场那条腿，以及茶摊天生的怀疑——他们愿意付多少。“一个直接的问题抵得上一根证据的棍子，”林伟说，“我们不引入任何听众看不见的东西。”不同的人，同样的困难：一个关于东市场、展会、西厅地面和这笔投资那条腿的直接问题。我们可以想象一个贫穷家庭的伤痛，但在表决之前，茶和那根证据的棍子必须被拿出来。世界对城市、大脑对预算、共和派对进步派：一场破产、一个皈依者，以及一次郊游，就是这个党能提供的全部。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
world wɜ:ld POS: n	n. 世界, 地球, 宇宙, 万物, 世人, 人间, 领域, 世事, 世故, 社会生活, 大量; [法] 世界, 地球, 世人 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. people in general; especially a distinctive group of people with some shared interest; n. all of your exper...
show ʃəʊ POS: n	n. 显示, 表现, 展览, 卖弄, 炫耀, 外观, 演出, 洋相; vt. 表示, 显示, 展现, 陈列, 演出, 表明, 指出, 带领; ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the act of publicly exhibiting or entertaining; n. a social event involving a public performance or enterta...
party 'pɑ:ti POS: n	n. 宴会, 党, 政党, 团体, 当事人, 聚会; v. 举办聚会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an organization to gain political power; n. a group of people gathered together for pleasure; n. a band of p...
evidence 'evidəns POS: n	n. 根据, 证据, 迹象; [经] 证据, 凭证 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. your basis for belief or disbelief; knowledge on which to base belief; n. an indication that makes somethin...
meeting 'mi:tiŋ POS: n	n. 会议, 会面; [法] 会议, 会谈, 集会 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a formally arranged gathering; n. a small informal social gathering; n. a casual or unexpected convergence; n...
poor puə, pɒ: POS: a	a. 贫穷的, 贫乏的, 不幸的, 可怜的, 拙劣的, 卑鄙的; [经] 低劣的, 不良的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. having little money or few possessions; a. characterized by or indicating poverty; a. lacking in specific re...
wrong rɒŋ POS: a	a. 错误的, 不正当的, 失常的; adv. 错误地 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. that which is contrary to the principles of justice or law; n. any harm or injury resulting from a violatio...
introduce ,intrə'dju:s POS: vt	vt. 介绍, 引入, 采用, 输入; [法] 引进, 输入, 介绍 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. cause to come to know personally; v. bring something new to an environment; v. bring in or establish in a ne...
article 'ɑ:tɪkl POS: n	n. 文章, 冠词, 物品, 物件, 条款, 契约; [计] 信件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. nonfictional prose forming an independent part of a publication; n. one of a class of artifacts; n. a separa...
democratic ,demə'krætɪk POS: a	a. 民主的; [法] 民主的, 民主政体的, 平民的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. characterized by or advocating or based upon the principles of democracy or social equality; a. belong to o...
bear beə POS: n	n. 熊; vt. 忍受, 支承, 产生, 怀有, 通过卖空使跌价; vi. 忍受, 结果实, 压挤, 行进, 转向 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. massive plantigrade carnivorous or omnivorous mammals with long shaggy coats and strong claws; n. an invest...
audience 'ɔ:diəns POS: n	n. 听众, 观众, 读者; [法] 听讼, 观众, 听众 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a gathering of spectators or listeners at a (usually public) performance; n. the part of the general public...
representative ,reprɪ'zentətɪv POS: n	n. 代表, 众议员, 典型; a. 描写的, 表现的, 代理的, 代表的, 代议制的, 典型的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who represents others; s. serving to represent or typify; a. standing for something else; s. being o...
conservative kən'sə:vətɪv POS: a	a. 保守的, 守旧的, 有保存力的; [化] 防腐剂; 保存剂 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is reluctant to accept changes and new ideas; n. a member of a Conservative Party; a. resistant...
corporate 'kɒ:pərɪt POS: a	a. 社团的, 合伙的, 公司的; [经] 团体的, 法人的, 社团的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: a. of or belonging to a corporation; s. done by or characteristic of individuals acting together; s. organized...
minority maɪ'nɒrɪti POS: n	n. 少数, 未成年, 少数民族; a. 少数的, 属于少数派的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of people who differ racially or politically from a larger group of which it is a part; n. being or...
jury 'dʒʊəri POS: n	n. 陪审团, 评判委员会; a. 应急的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a body of citizens sworn to give a true verdict according to the evidence presented in a court of law; n. a...
acknowledge ək'nɒlɪdʒ POS: vt	vt. 承认, 告知收悉, 答谢, 报偿; [经] 承认, 答谢, 收到的通知 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. report the receipt of; v. express obligation, thanks, or gratitude for; v. accept as legally binding and val...
revenue 'revɪnju: POS: n	n. 收入, 岁入, 税收, 税务局; [经] 岁入, 税收, 税务局 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n the entire amount of income before any deductions are made; n government income due to taxation

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
politician ˈpɒlɪtɪʃən POS: n	n. 政客, 政治家, 从事党派政治的人; [法] 政客, 政治家 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a leader engaged in civil administration; n. a person active in party politics; n. a schemer who tries to ga...
bond bɒnd POS: n	n. 捆绑物, 结合, 债券, 契约, 粘合剂, 保证人, 键, 关栈保留; vt. 存入关栈, 使黏合; vi. 结合 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a certificate of debt (usually interest-bearing or discounted) that is issued by a government or corporati...
convert kən'veɪt POS: n	n. 皈依者, 改变宗教信仰者; vt. 使改变信仰, 转换, 兑换, 倒置; vi. 皈依; [计] 转换 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who has been converted to another religious or political belief; v. change from one system to anot...
jail dʒeɪl POS: n	n. 监牢, 监狱, 拘留所; vt. 监禁, 下狱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a correctional institution used to detain persons who are in the lawful custody of the government (either...
terrorism 'terərɪzəm POS: n	n. 恐怖主义, 恐怖统治, 恐怖状态; [法] 胁迫, 暴政, 恐怖政治 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the calculated use of violence (or the threat of violence) against civilians in order to attain goals that...
vacation veɪ'keɪʃən POS: n	n. 假期, 休假; [法] 假期, 停审期, 休庭期 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. leisure time away from work devoted to rest or pleasure; n. the act of making something legally void; v. spe...
terrorist 'terərɪst POS: n	n. 恐怖分子; [法] 恐怖份子, 恐怖主义 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a radical who employs terror as a political weapon; usually organizes with other terrorists in small cells...
taxation tæk'seɪʃən POS: n	n. 课税, 征税, 抽税, 税款, 估定的税额; [经] 征税, 纳税, 税制 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the imposition of taxes; the practice of the government in levying taxes on the subjects of a state
versus 'vɜ:səs POS: prep	prep. 对...; [法] 诉, 对, 相形 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: prep. Against; as, John Doe versus Richard Roe; — chiefly, used in legal language, and abbreviated to v. o...
allegation ,æli'geɪʃən POS: n	n. 断言, 主张, 申辩; [法] 声明, 事实陈述, 断言 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (law) a formal accusation against somebody (often in a court of law); n. statements affirming or denying ce...
succession sək'seʃən POS: n	n. 连续, 继承权, 继位, 演替, 地层次序; [法] 继承, 继承权, 继位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group of people or things arranged or following in order; n. the action of following in order; n. (ecology...
lobby 'lɒbi POS: n	n. 大厅, 休息室, 游说议员者; vi. 游说议员, 游说; vt. 游说 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the people who support some common cause or business or principle or sectional interest; n. a group of peop...
progressive prə'gresɪv POS: n	n. 改革论者, 进步论者; a. 前进的, 累进的, 进步的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a tense of verbs used in describing action that is on-going; a. favoring or promoting progress; s. favoring...
bankruptcy 'bæŋkrəptsi POS: n	n. 破产者; [经] 破产, 倒闭 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a state of complete lack of some abstract property; n. inability to discharge all your debts as they come d...
fare feə POS: n	n. 费用, 旅客, 食物; vi. 进展, 进步, 经营, 过活 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the sum charged for riding in a public conveyance; n. a paying (taxi) passenger; n. the food and drink that...
confession kən'feʃən POS: n	n. 承认, 坦白, 招供; [法] 自白, 招供, 自认有罪 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an admission of misdeeds or faults; n. a written document acknowledging an offense and signed by the guilty...
nuisance 'nju:snəs POS: n	n. 讨厌的东西, 讨厌的人, 损害; [医] 损害, 讨厌 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (law) a broad legal concept including anything that disturbs the reasonable use of your property or endang...
transcript 'trænskɪpt POS: n	n. 抄本, 副本, 成绩单; [法] 法院文本, 官方记录, 记录的副本 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. something that has been transcribed; a written record (usually typewritten) of dictated or recorded speech...
outing 'aʊtɪŋ POS: n	n. 郊游, 远足; a. 远足适用的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n a journey taken for pleasure; n a day devoted to an outdoor social gathering; v to state openly and publicly...
socialize 'səʊʃəlaɪz POS: vt	vt. 使社会化, 使社会主义化, 使适合社会需要; vi. (美) (非正式) 参加社交活动, 发生社交往来 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. take part in social activities; interact with others; v. train for a social environment; v. prepare for soci...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
condemnation kɒndem'neɪʃən POS: n	n. 非难, 宣告有罪, 非难的理由 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (law) the act of condemning (as land forfeited for public use) or judging to be unfit for use (as a food p...
contentious kən'tenʃəs POS: a	a. 好争吵的, 爱争论的, 有异议的; [法] 诉讼的, 争执的, 引起争论的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. inclined or showing an inclination to dispute or disagree, even to engage in law suits; s. involving or lik...
reformation ˌrefə'meɪʃən POS: n	n. 改革, 改正, 重新形成, 重新组成 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. improvement (or an intended improvement) in the existing form or condition of institutions or practices et...
piracy 'paɪərəsi POS: n	n. 海盗行为, 海上劫掠, 剽窃, 著作权侵害, 非法翻印; [法] 海盗行为, 海上掠夺, 海盗罪 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. hijacking on the high seas or in similar contexts; taking a ship or plane away from the control of those w...
defection dɪ'fekʃən POS: n	n. 背叛, 缺乏, 毛病; [法] 缺点, 过失, 背叛 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n withdrawing support or help despite allegiance or responsibility; n the state of having rejected your religi...